Answer Key – MG3DSCSOC202: Social Life – Forms and Dynamics

Paper 1

Course: *MG3DSCSOC201 – Understanding Social Institutions: Marriage and Family*
Maximum Marks: 50

Part A – Very Short Answers (2 marks each)

1. **Social Institution:** A structured system of norms and values governing specific aspects of social life, such as family, education, or religion. [U]/[CO1]

2. **Social Reform Movement:** The Brahmo Samaj, led by Raja Ram Mohan Roy, reformed marriage practices by opposing child marriage and promoting widow remarriage. [U]/[CO1]

3. **Postmodern Views:** Marriage is seen as fluid, negotiated, and individualized rather than permanent or institutionally fixed. [U]/[CO2]

4. **Symbolic Interactionism:** Focuses on micro-level meanings people assign to family roles and interactions. [U]/[CO2]

5. **Disruptive Family Dynamics:** Patterns of conflict, abuse, or neglect that disturb harmony within a family. [K]/[CO3]

6. **Protection Order:** A legal measure preventing an abuser from contacting or approaching the victim. [U]/[CO4]

7. **Conflict Theory:** Highlights power inequalities and how economic or gender tensions create conflicts in marriage. [K]/[CO2]

8. **Void Marriage:** Declared invalid if prohibited degrees of relationship exist or either party is already married. [U]/[CO4]

9. **Exchange Theory:** Partner selection is viewed as cost-benefit analysis based on emotional and material rewards. [U]/[CO2]

10. **Advantage of Cohabitation:** Provides emotional companionship and flexibility without legal obligations. [K]/[CO5]

11. **Advantages of Legalizing Same-Sex Marriage:** Promotes equality and ensures legal protection and inheritance rights. [U]/[CO5]

12. **New Reproductive Technologies:** Medical techniques aiding conception, e.g., In Vitro Fertilization (IVF). [K]/[CO5]

13. **Single-Parent vs. Nuclear Family:** Single-parent—one adult caregiver; Nuclear—two parents with children. [K]/[CO5]

14. **Divorce vs. Separation:** Divorce legally ends marriage; separation only suspends cohabitation. [U]/[CO4]

15. **Reasons for Singleness:** Career preference; fear of financial or emotional dependency. [K]/[CO5]

16. **Impact of Single Population:** Increases demand for individual housing and alters urban lifestyle patterns. [A]/[CO5]

Part – B

Short Answers (6 marks each)

17a. Emergence of Sociology from Revolutions [U]/[CO1]

The Enlightenment fostered rational inquiry; the French Revolution challenged feudalism and hierarchy; the Industrial Revolution generated new urban classes and social problems. Together they institutionalised sociology as a science addressing order and change.

17b. Berger's "Professional Peeper" Metaphor [U]/[CO1]

Berger's metaphor captures the sociologist's curiosity and moral responsibility. The sociologist observes everyday life critically yet ethically, unveiling taken-for-granted norms without voyeurism. It balances detachment with empathy.

18a. Education, Digitalisation, and Youth Identity [An]/[CO3]

Digital technology shapes self-presentation, community, and values. In Kerala, access to education and online culture reconfigures class, language, and gender relations, creating hybrid youth identities and new social networks.

18b. Transformation of Matrilineal System in Kerala [An]/[CO3]

Transition from taravad (matrilineal joint family) to nuclear units eroded female property rights but promoted individual autonomy. Legal reforms

(Marumakkathayam Act 1933) shifted inheritance and authority, redefining gender dynamics.

19a. Social Change and Indian National Movement [An]/[CO3]

The movement fostered unity across caste and religion, promoted women's participation, and laid foundations of democratic citizenship. It embedded nationalism within everyday moral life.

19b. Tradition and Modernity in India [An]/[CO3]

Indian modernity fuses continuity with change—ritual coexistence with technology, caste persistence with new mobility. Sociological duality reveals adaptation rather than rupture.

20a. Functions of Mass Media [U]/[CO4]

Media informs, educates, entertains, and socialises citizens, linking individuals to the public sphere. It reinforces norms but also stimulates reform through exposure and debate.

20b. Glocalization in Culture [A]/[CO4]

Global brands adapt to local tastes—McDonald's India offers vegetarian menus; fashion integrates traditional motifs with modern design. This hybridization preserves cultural identity while embracing global influence.